

Interac e-Transfer — Support Knowledge Base

A reference guide for the e-Transfer Support Agent

Illustrative workshop document. Company names, limits, and fees are fictional/sample values for demonstration only and do not represent real Interac or financial-institution figures.

1. What is Interac e-Transfer?

Interac e-Transfer is a service that lets customers send, request, and receive money electronically between bank accounts at participating Canadian financial institutions, using only the recipient's email address or mobile phone number. Money moves directly between bank accounts; the sender and recipient do not share account numbers with each other.

There are three common actions a customer can take:

- **Send money** — transfer funds to another person or business.
- **Request money** — ask another person or business to send you funds; they approve the request from their banking app.
- **Receive money** — accept an incoming transfer, either by answering a security question or automatically via Autodeposit.

2. How to Send Money

To send an e-Transfer, the customer signs in to their online or mobile banking, selects Interac e-Transfer, chooses or adds a recipient (email or mobile number), enters the amount, and — unless the recipient uses Autodeposit — sets a security question and answer.

The recipient receives a notification and either has the funds deposited automatically (Autodeposit) or clicks the link, selects their financial institution, and answers the security question to deposit the money.

Security question tips: choose a question only the recipient can answer, avoid sharing the answer in the same channel as the transfer notification, and never reuse obvious answers. This step protects the transfer if the notification is intercepted.

3. Autodeposit

Autodeposit lets a recipient have incoming e-Transfers deposited directly into their account without answering a security question. The recipient registers their email or mobile number and links it to a deposit account once; after that, eligible transfers are deposited automatically, usually within seconds.

Autodeposit improves both speed and security: because there is no security question to guess or intercept, it reduces the risk of transfer interception fraud.

4. Sending Limits by Account Tier

Sending limits depend on the customer's account tier. The sample limits below are used by the e-Transfer assistant tool in this workshop (all amounts in CAD):

Account tier	Per transaction	Daily	Weekly	Monthly	Send fee
Personal Basic	\$3,000	\$3,000	\$10,000	\$20,000	\$0.00
Personal Premium	\$5,000	\$10,000	\$20,000	\$40,000	\$0.00
Small Business	\$25,000	\$50,000	\$100,000	\$250,000	\$1.50

If a requested transfer exceeds the per-transaction limit for the customer's tier, the transfer cannot be completed as a single transaction. The customer can split it into smaller transfers (within daily/weekly/monthly limits) or contact their financial institution about a higher tier.

5. Fees

For most personal account tiers in this workshop, sending and receiving e-Transfers is free. Requesting money is always free. Small Business accounts pay a flat send fee of \$1.50 CAD per outgoing transfer. Actual fees vary by financial institution and account type.

6. Delivery Times

- **With Autodeposit:** funds are deposited within seconds, with no security question.
- **Without Autodeposit:** the transfer typically completes within 30 minutes, once the recipient accepts it and answers the security question. It can take longer if the recipient delays accepting.
- **Request money:** the request is delivered immediately; funds arrive only after the other party approves the request.

7. Security Best Practices

- Only send money to people you know and trust — e-Transfers are like cash and are hard to reverse once deposited.
- Use Autodeposit where possible to remove the security-question step.
- If using a security question, pick one with an answer that is not easy to guess and not shared alongside the transfer.
- Be alert to fraud: Interac and financial institutions never ask customers to send an e-Transfer to 'verify', 'protect', or 'move' their money.
- Never click links in unexpected e-Transfer notifications; instead, log in to your banking app directly.
- Report suspected fraud to your financial institution immediately.

8. Interac e-Transfer for Business

Businesses can use Interac e-Transfer to send and receive payments, including bulk disbursements and Request Money for invoicing. Business accounts have higher limits (see the Small Business tier above) and may incur a per-transfer send fee. Business transfers can carry richer remittance details to help with reconciliation.

9. Frequently Asked Questions

Can I cancel an e-Transfer? A transfer can usually be cancelled only if the recipient has not yet deposited it and it was not sent via Autodeposit. Once deposited, it cannot be reversed.

What happens if the recipient never accepts? Unclaimed transfers expire after a set period (commonly 30 days) and the funds are returned to the sender's account.

Why was my transfer declined? Common reasons include exceeding the per-transaction, daily, weekly, or monthly limit for the account tier, insufficient funds, or the recipient's email/mobile not being valid.

Is there a fee to receive money? No — receiving an e-Transfer is free.

How do I increase my limits? Limits are set by the financial institution and account tier. Customers can contact their institution to discuss a higher tier.